



Scaling and Root Planing (Deep Cleaning)

Purpose: Removal of plaque and tartar from below the gumline to treat gum disease.

First 24 Hours:

- Mild tooth sensitivity and gum soreness are common.
- Avoid eating until numbness wears off to prevent injury.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Use OTC pain relievers as needed.
- Tooth sensitivity to hot, cold, or sweets may last for several weeks.
- Desensitizing toothpaste may help.

Oral Hygiene:

- Brush gently but thoroughly twice daily.
- Floss carefully to avoid injuring the gums.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinse if provided.

Diet:

- Soft foods for the first day if gums are sore.
- Avoid sticky, hard, or crunchy foods until comfortable.

Bleeding:

- Mild gum bleeding during brushing or flossing is normal for several days.
- Continue good oral hygiene to promote healing.

Follow-Up:

- Schedule maintenance cleanings every 3–4 months.
- Contact the office if swelling, severe pain, or heavy bleeding occurs.